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Culture (OWC): [San \(FX10\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Southern Africa

Field Date: 1958-1966

Coverage Date: 1950-1966

Place Coverage

G/wi, Central Kalahari Game Reserve, Botswana

Section Title(S): SOCIAL ORDER

Behavior toward other kin, the joking relatives, is free of such restraint. Instead, mutual teasing, uninhibited joking and criticism, free use of one another's property, and, between relatives of opposite sex and comparable age, mildly provocative flirting and a certain amount of erotic bodily contact are expected.

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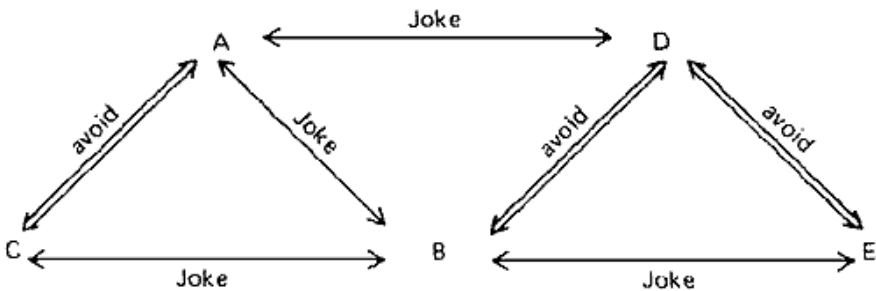
All kin are expected to *wiku* (love one another), to behave affectionately to one another and to be helpful and generous.

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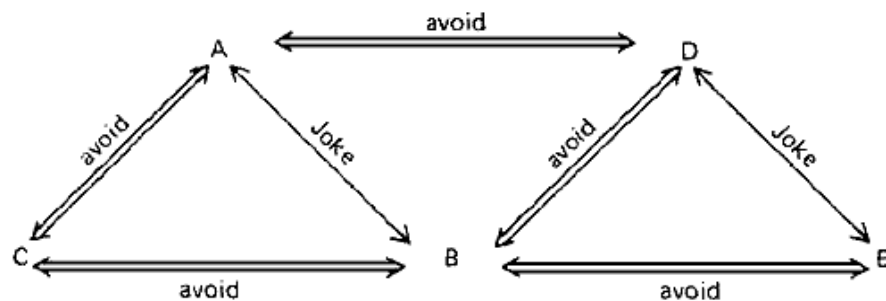
In the categorizing of kin as joking or avoidance, generations are alternated, so that the generation proximate to that of a joking relative is in the avoidance category, and vice versa. The result is that an individual is on joking terms with the joking kin of his joking partners and must respect his avoidance kin. Were this not so, the embarrassing situation could arise in which B jokes with A's avoidance relative C, and with A simultaneously; for example,

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This should not happen; instead, what should be is:



This ordering of relationships might be termed the principle of congruent triangles. There are some situations in which it does not operate, for example, both cross-cousins and their parents are in the joking category, but this is changed if ego marries his cross-cousin, in which case the latter's parents are transferred to the avoidance category.

Avoidance kin are those between whom there exists, or potentially exists, a relationship involving authority and submission; this relationship is extended to kin who, actually or by classification, are in a parent-child [312](#) relationship with ego or with ego's spouse. Kinship terms coincide with the joking-avoidance categories, and the following terms are applied to people who are in the avoidance category:

ba:ma (father; matri- and patrilineal great grandfather and great grandson, the generation after persons termed *n//odima* or the female equivalent, *n//odisa*)

gje:sa (mother)

ba:g/wâma (FBr, MSill, great grandfather)

gje:g/wâsa (female counterpart of *ba:g/wâma*)

g/wâ (-*ma* or -*sa*) (ego's children, children of siblings of same sex, grandchildren of sibling of opposite sex, children of parallel cousin of same sex, the generation younger than *n//odima* or *n//odisa*—in which case this term is an alternative to *ba:ma* and *ba:sa*)

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